



1882

Disposition patterning Attractive floral prints or weaves *à la disposition* – with different patterns in the same colourway, used together – were popular. Forehead fringes appeared in high society, but were disallowed for maids.



1883

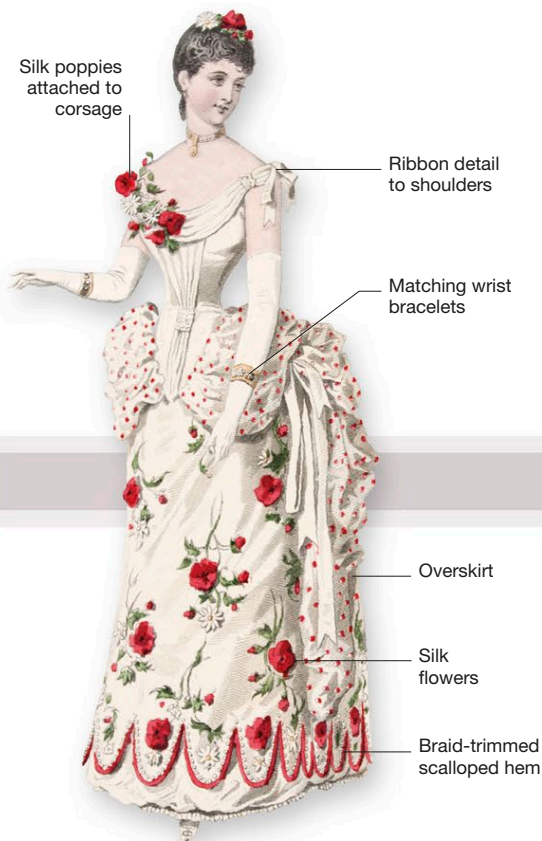
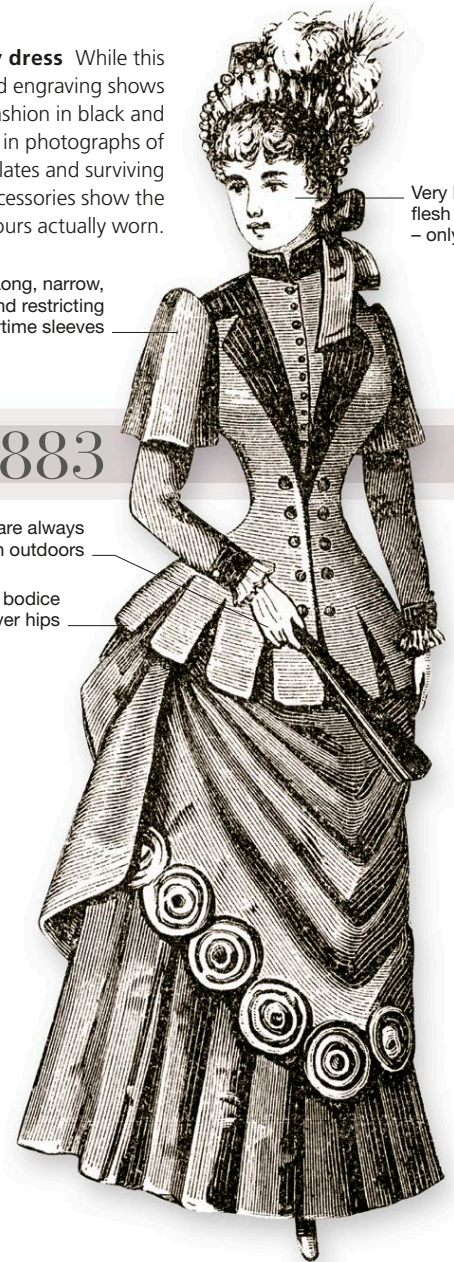
German day dress While this sculptural wood engraving shows contemporary fashion in black and white, as also seen in photographs of the time, fashion plates and surviving dresses and accessories show the range of colours actually worn.

Long, narrow, and restricting daytime sleeves

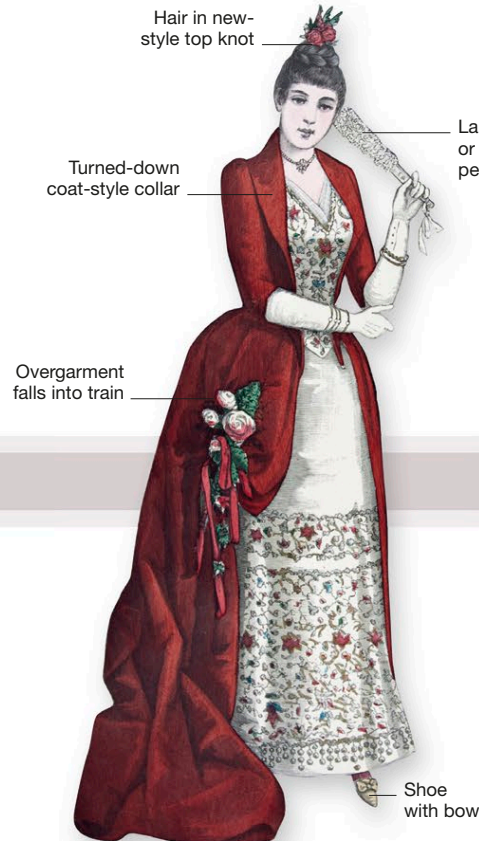
Very little flesh shows – only face

Gloves are always worn outdoors

Tabbed bodice splays over hips



Ball dress This design from Madrid would require a skilful dressmaker to swathe spotted fabric over the hips, attach silk flowers, and make the rigid understructures of whalebone and steel disappear.



Evening dress This Spanish dress and bodice are exquisitely embroidered. The trained overgarment adds warmth and elegance. This fashion plate, along with the three to the left, show the range of styles in Spain in a single year.

FANS

Fans were produced in huge numbers. They were the perfect gift – as was Lady Windermere's fan in the 1892 Oscar Wilde play of the same name – and useful in a warm ballroom or theatre. The early 18th century language of the fan was largely lost by the late 19th century, but might at least allow a female to signal interest or otherwise to a gentleman admirer.



Fan with mother-of-pearl sticks and guards

